transferred to PRIs and since 2004 there has also been massive transfer of funds to PRIs, especially after the enactment of the MGNREGA.

But institutionally the ***PRIs remain weak*** and do not have the required capacity to plan or implement programmes effectively. The *12th Plan* proposes a 'complete break from the past' and provides sizeable resources to the Ministry of Panchayati Raj. These higher outlays should be converted into *outcomes*. This calls for greater *focus on empowering PRIs* through training and awareness generation coupled with social audit of all social sector programmes. Cash transfers to the intended beneficiaries can also help empower citizens, even while giving them choice of provider. This too can help improve the quality of *service delivery*.

To the extent the GoI is concerned, the issues highlighted by the *Survey* are neither new nor un-attended. But the main thing is that in a democracy things can only move in the desired direction once there is required level of public awareness and participation in place – the things for which the PRI level planning was given Constitutional status by the Constitutional Amendments 73rd and 74th. It is a matter of time that the PRIs start functioning in their right mode and the dream of inclusive growth and development gets realised – we can work in this direction with all zeal.

Note to Sources: Analyses and comments articulated in this chapter are based on the notes and suggestions provided by some of the most noted economists and public policy-makers of India such as – Amartya Sen, ***Development as Freedom***, OUP, N. Delhi, 2000; Amartya Sen & Jean Dreze, ***Indian Development***, OUP, N. Delhi, 1996; Jeffrey D. Sachs, A. Varshney and Nirupam Bajpai, ***India in the Era of Economic Reforms***, OUP, N. Delhi, 1999, pp. 74–80; Kaushik Basu ed., ***India's Emerging Economy***, OUP, N. Delhi, 2004. & I.J. Ahhiwalia and I.M.D. Little (eds), ***India's Economic Reforms and Development***, OUP, N. Delhi, 1998; ***India Development Report 2004–05***, Oxford University Press, N. Delhi, 2005, pp. 40–61, 62–81, 96–111; Suresh D. Tendulkar & T.A. Bhavani, ***Understanding Reforms: Post 1991 India***, Oxford University Press, N. Delhi, 2007; various issue of the ***Economic Survey***, MoF, GoI, N. Delhi